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Attorneys for Defendant
KATIE PALACIOS and
HOPE PROGRAM, A LICENSED CLINICAL SOCIAL WORKER PROFESSIONAL CORPORATION (sued and served as The Hope Program)

SUPERIOR COURT OF THE STATE OF CALIFORNIA

COUNTY OF SAN JOAQUIN

BRENDAN NGEHSI NEWANFORBI, Plaintiff, v. KATIE PALACIOS, Clinical Director, HOPE Program (Stockton, California), an individual; HOPE PSYCHOTHERAPY, INC., d/b/a HOPE PROGRAM, a California corporation; and DOES 1-10, inclusive, Defendants.	Case No.: STK-CV-UF-2026-0001032 **DEFENDANT KATIE PALACIOS' RESPONSES TO PLAINTIFF'S REQUESTS FOR ADMISSION, SET ONE** Complaint Filed: February 10, 2026 Trial Date: TBD

PROPOUNDING PARTY: Plaintiff BRENDAN NGEHSI NEWANFORBI

RESPONDING PARTY: Defendant KATIE PALACIOS

SET NO: ONE

Defendant KATIE PALACIOS ("PALACIOS" or "Defendant" or "Responding Party") hereby objects and responds to Plaintiff BRENDAN NGEHSI NEWANFORBI's ("Propounding Party") Requests for Admission, Set One, as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

The following responses are made solely for the purpose of this pending action. Documents eventually produced in response to the Requests for Admission and any individual request therein, are subject to admissibility, as well as to any and all other objections on any grounds that would require the exclusion of any statement therein if the information were introduced in court. All objections and grounds for such objections are expressly reserved and may be interposed at the time of any motion or trial. These responses are based on discovery available as of the date hereof. Discovery is continuing, and these responses are accordingly subject to revision. Further discovery, independent investigation, and analysis may supply additional facts and add meaning to known facts, as well as establish entirely new factual conclusions and legal contentions, all of which may lead to additions, changes to, or variations from the information set forth herein. These responses are given without prejudice to Defendant's right to produce, respond, or rely on subsequently discovered information, facts, or documents. Defendant accordingly reserves the right to change the response herein as additional facts are ascertained, analysis is made, legal research is completed, and contentions are made. The responses contained herein are made in a good faith effort to comply with the provisions of the California Rules of Civil Procedure but are in no way deemed to prejudice Defendant with respect to further discovery, research, and analysis.

RESPONSES TO REQUESTS FOR ADMISSION, SET ONE

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 1:

Admit that, at all relevant times during the RELEVANT PERIOD, YOU served as Site Director (or comparable supervisory position) at the STOCKTON FACILITY.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 1

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the terms "Site Director", and "comparable supervisory position".

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Admit.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 2:

Admit that, at all relevant times during the RELEVANT PERIOD, YOU had personal

authority to recommend, withhold, or veto a treatment-completion determination for parolee participants at the STOCKTON FACILITY.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 2:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague, ambiguous, and unintelligible as to the terms "personal authority", "recommend, withhold, or to veto", "treatment-completion." Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 3:

Admit that, at all relevant times during the RELEVANT PERIOD, the HOPE clinician identified as "Bernadette" reported, directly or indirectly, to YOU.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 3:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague, ambiguous, and unintelligible as to the phrase "reported, directly or indirectly." Responding Party further objects to the extent this request calls for a legal conclusion and/or expert opinion.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Responding Party admits that during the relevant period they served as a manager to clinician Bernadette Marie Tassone.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 4:

Admit that YOU attended one or more CTMs concerning PLAINTIFF during the RELEVANT PERIOD.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 4:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the terms "attended", and "one or more". Responding Party also objects that this request is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows:

Admit.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 5:

Admit that, during the RELEVANT PERIOD, YOU did not recommend a treatment-completion determination for any parolee participant at the STOCKTON FACILITY prior to that parolee's discharge from parole.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 5:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "treatment-completion determination" and unintelligible as phrased.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 6:

Admit that, at all CTMs concerning PLAINTIFF that YOU attended during the RELEVANT PERIOD, YOU did not recommend that PLAINTIFF be deemed to have completed treatment.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 6:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the term "be deemed to have completed" and unintelligible as phrased. Responding Party objects that this request is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Admit.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 7:

Admit that YOU were aware, at all relevant times during the RELEVANT PERIOD, that HOPE's policy was to retain parolee participants in treatment for the entire duration of parole.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 7:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the term "policy" and unintelligible as phrased. Responding Party further objects to the extent this request calls for a legal conclusion and/or expert opinion. Responding Party further objects to the extent this request assumes facts not in evidence, calls for speculation, and requires an assumption, specifically that HOPE's policy was to retain parolee participants in treatment for the

entire duration of parole.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 8:

Admit that YOU did not present, review with, or provide a copy of the October 18, 2023 Treatment Completion Plan authored by the HOPE clinician identified as "Bernadette" to PLAINTIFF at any time from October 18, 2023 through the present.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 8:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "Treatment Completion Plan" and unintelligible as phrased. Responding Party also objects that this request is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party further objects to the extent this request calls for a legal conclusion and/or expert opinion. Responding Party further objects to the extent this request assumes facts not in evidence, calls for speculation, and requires an assumption, specifically that there was an October 18, 2023 Treatment Completion Plan authored by the HOPE clinician identified as "Bernadette".

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Admit.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 9:

Admit that YOU did not personally administer to PLAINTIFF any Mason-protocol progress review, structured progress assessment, or comparable validated risk-or-progress instrument during the RELEVANT PERIOD.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 9:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the terms "personally administer", "Mason-protocol progress review, structured progress assessment, or comparable validated risk-or-progress instrument". Responding Party also objects that this request is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party further objects to the extent this request calls for a legal conclusion and/or expert opinion.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows:

Responding Party has no knowledge of the meaning of "Mason-protocol progress review, structured progress assessment, or comparable validated risk-or-progress instrument" and, therefore, can neither admit nor deny this request.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 10:

Admit that YOU did not direct any other clinician to administer to PLAINTIFF any Mason-protocol progress review, structured progress assessment, or comparable validated risk-or-progress instrument during the RELEVANT PERIOD.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 10:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the terms "direct", "administer", "Mason-protocol progress review, structured progress assessment, or comparable validated risk-or-progress instrument". Responding Party also objects that this request is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party further objects to the extent this request calls for a legal conclusion and/or expert opinion.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows:

Responding Party has no knowledge of the meaning of "Mason-protocol progress review, structured progress assessment, or comparable validated risk-or-progress instrument" and, therefore, can neither admit nor deny this request.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 11:

Admit that, at the August 2025 CTM concerning PLAINTIFF held at a CDCR parole office in Stockton, YOU stated, in substance, that PLAINTIFF was "disruptive," or words to that effect.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 11:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the as to the phrase "in substance". Responding Party also objects that this request is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to

each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Admit.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 12:

Admit that, at the August 2025 CTM, YOU stated, in substance, that PLAINTIFF was a "ringleader," or words to that effect.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 12:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the as to the terms “in substance” and “that effect”. Responding Party objects that this request is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Admit.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 13:

Admit that, at the August 2025 CTM, YOU stated, in substance, that PLAINTIFF's behavior was "abhorrent," or words to that effect.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 13:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the as to the terms “in substance” and “that effect”. Responding Party also objects that this request is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

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REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 14:

Admit that, at the August 2025 CTM, YOU stated, in substance, that PLAINTIFF was "often disrespectful," or words to that effect.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 14:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the as to the terms “in substance” and “that effect”. Responding Party also objects that this request is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 15:

Admit that, at the August 2025 CTM, YOU characterized PLAINTIFF's respectful demeanor at that meeting as an "acting job," or words to that effect.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 15:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the term “demeanor” and unintelligible as phrased. Responding Party further objects to the extent this request assumes facts not in evidence, calls for speculation, and requires an assumption, specifically that PLAINTIFF displayed “respectful demeanor at that meeting”. Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 16:

Admit that, at the August 2025 CTM, YOU stated, in substance, "because when you start complaining then the other guys chime in," or words to that effect.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 16:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "in substance" and unintelligible as phrased. Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Admit.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 17:

Admit that, on or about August 2025, in a HOPE group session at the STOCKTON FACILITY that was video-recorded, YOU stated, in substance, that HOPE "routinely loses client homework packets," or words to that effect.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 17:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "in substance" and unintelligible as phrased. Responding Party also objects that this request is overbroad and burdensome in time and/or scope and therefore seeks information that is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party objects to the extent this request seeks to invade the attorney work product privilege, attorney client privilege and seeks information protected by Code of Civil Procedure § 2034.010 et seq. Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 18:

Admit that, during one or more calendar years in the RELEVANT PERIOD, some portion of YOUR compensation from HOPE was tied, directly or indirectly, to client census, client retention duration, sessions delivered, or site-level revenue at the STOCKTON FACILITY.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 18:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the terms "portion", "compensation", "tied, directly or indirectly," "client retention duration," "sessions delivered", and "site-level revenue". Responding Party also objects that this request is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party further objects to the extent this request calls for a legal conclusion and/or expert opinion.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 19:

Admit that YOU did not receive any compensation, bonus, or incentive from HOPE that was tied to PLAINTIFF's discharge from HOPE's program.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 19:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the terms "compensation", "bonus", "incentive", "was tied to", and "discharge". Responding Party also objects that this request is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party further objects to the extent this request calls for a legal conclusion and/or expert opinion. Responding Party objects to the extent this request seeks to invade the attorney work product privilege, attorney client privilege and seeks information protected by Code of Civil Procedure § 2034.010 et seq. Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 20:

Admit that YOU first became aware of DWYER on or before December 31, 2023.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 20:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the terms "became aware" and "DWYER". Responding Party further objects to the

extent this request assumes facts not in evidence, calls for speculation, and requires an assumption, specifically that there is a "DWYER." Responding Party further objects to the extent this request calls for a legal conclusion and/or expert opinion. Responding Party objects to the extent this request seeks to invade the attorney work product privilege, attorney client privilege and seeks information protected by Code of Civil Procedure § 2034.010 et seq. Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 21:

Admit that YOU did not modify YOUR clinical practice or YOUR treatment-completion recommendations for parolee participants in any material respect after becoming aware of DWYER.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 21:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the terms "became aware" and "DWYER". Responding Party further objects to the extent this request assumes facts not in evidence, calls for speculation, and requires an assumption, specifically that there is a "DWYER." Responding Party also objects that this request is overbroad and burdensome in time and/or scope and therefore seeks information that is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party further objects to the extent this request calls for a legal conclusion and/or expert opinion. Responding Party objects to the extent this request seeks to invade the attorney work product privilege, attorney client privilege and seeks information protected by Code of Civil Procedure § 2034.010 et seq.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 22:

Admit that YOU first became aware of the April 17, 2025 amendments to 15 C.C.R. section 3574 on or before December 31, 2025.

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RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 22:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "became aware". Responding Party also objects that this request is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party further objects to the extent this request calls for a legal conclusion and/or expert opinion. Responding Party objects to the extent this request seeks to invade the attorney work product privilege, attorney client privilege and seeks information protected by Code of Civil Procedure § 2034.010 et seq.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 23:

Admit that YOU did not modify YOUR clinical practice or YOUR treatment-completion recommendations for parolee participants in any material respect after April 17, 2025.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 23:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the terms "any material respect" and "treatment completion." Responding Party also objects that this request is overbroad and burdensome in time and/or scope and therefore seeks information that is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party objects to the extent this request seeks to invade the attorney work product privilege, attorney client privilege and seeks information protected by Code of Civil Procedure § 2034.010 et seq. Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 24:

Admit that, during the RELEVANT PERIOD, YOU instructed or otherwise communicated to one or more HOPE clinicians under YOUR supervision that no parolee participant should be deemed to have completed treatment prior to parole discharge.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 24

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "should be deemed" and unintelligible as phrased. Responding Party also objects that this request is overbroad and burdensome in time and/or scope and therefore seeks information that is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party objects to the extent this request seeks to invade the attorney work product privilege, attorney client privilege and seeks information protected by Code of Civil Procedure § 2034.010 et seq. Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 25:

Admit that, in or about June 2024, a HOPE clinician under YOUR supervision told PLAINTIFF, in substance, that no homework completed by PLAINTIFF had been found in HOPE's records.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 25:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "in substance" and unintelligible as phrased. Responding Party also objects that this request is overbroad and burdensome in time and/or scope and therefore seeks information that is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party objects to the extent this request seeks to invade the attorney work product privilege, attorney client privilege and seeks information protected by Code of Civil Procedure § 2034.010 et seq.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Responding Party has no knowledge of the alleged statement made by another party to Plaintiff in or about June 2024 and, therefore, can neither admit nor deny the request.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 26:

Admit that YOU were aware no later than December 31, 2022 that PLAINTIFF held a Class

A Commercial Driver's License (CDL).

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 26:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "were aware." Responding Party also objects that this request is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party further objects to the extent this request assumes facts not in evidence, calls for speculation, and requires an assumption, specifically that PLAINTIFF held a Class A Commercial Driver's License (CDL).

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 27:

Admit that YOU were aware no later than December 31, 2022 that PLAINTIFF was working as a CDL driver in commercial trucking.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 27:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the term "were aware" and unintelligible as phrased. Responding Party also objects that this request is overbroad and burdensome in time and/or scope and therefore seeks information that is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party objects to the extent this request seeks to invade the attorney work product privilege, attorney client privilege and seeks information protected by Code of Civil Procedure § 2034.010 et seq. Responding Party further objects to the extent this request assumes facts not in evidence, calls for speculation, and requires an assumption, specifically that PLAINTIFF was working as a CDL driver in commercial trucking.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 28:

Admit that YOU did not offer or make available to PLAINTIFF, at any time during the RELEVANT PERIOD, any telehealth, evening, weekend, or alternative-schedule accommodation specifically designed to accommodate his CDL employment.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 28:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "offer or make available" and unintelligible as phrased. Responding Party objects that this request seeks information that is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party further objects to the extent this request calls for a legal conclusion and/or expert opinion. Responding Party objects to the extent this request seeks to invade the attorney work product privilege, attorney client privilege and seeks information protected by Code of Civil Procedure § 2034.010 et seq. Responding Party further objects to the extent this request assumes facts not in evidence, calls for speculation, and requires an assumption, specifically that plaintiff had CDL employment.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Admit.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 29:

Admit that PLAINTIFF made one or more complaints, grievances, or requests to YOU or in YOUR presence prior to August 2025 regarding HOPE's retention policy, lost or mishandled homework, or another aspect of HOPE's program.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 29:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague and ambiguous as to the phrase "one or more" and unintelligible as phrased. Responding Party also objects that this request is overbroad and burdensome in time and/or scope and therefore seeks information that is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party further objects to the extent this request calls for a legal conclusion and/or expert opinion. Responding Party objects to the extent this request seeks to invade the attorney work product privilege, attorney client privilege and seeks information protected by Code of Civil Procedure § 2034.010 et seq. Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows:

Admit.

REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 30:

Admit that YOU were aware, at all relevant times during the RELEVANT PERIOD, that CDCR/DAPO relied upon HOPE's treatment-status reports — including reports prepared, reviewed, or signed by YOU — in making decisions about PLAINTIFF's parole conditions, GPS monitoring, curfew, and discharge.

RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR ADMISSION NO. 30:

Responding Party objects to this Request on the grounds that this request is vague, ambiguous and unintelligible as to the phrase "relied upon." Responding Party also objects that this request is overbroad and burdensome in time and/or scope and therefore seeks information that is not reasonably related to lead to the discovery of admissible evidence. Responding Party objects to the extent this request seeks to invade the attorney work product privilege, attorney client privilege and seeks information protected by Code of Civil Procedure § 2034.010 et seq. Responding Party further objects to the extent this request calls for a legal conclusion and/or expert opinion. Responding Party also objects that this request is compound, conjunct and disjunct, and improperly joins multiple distinct inquiries into a single question, making it difficult to provide a complete and accurate response to each component.

Subject to and without waiving the above objections, Responding Party responds as follows: Denied.

Dated: June 8, 2026

SIMS, LAWRENCE & BROGHAMMER

By: _____

CYNTHIA G. LAWRENCE
BRYAN L. MALONE
BLAZE VAN DINE
Attorneys for Defendants,
KATIE PALACIOS and
HOPE PROGRAM

VERIFICATION

I, KATIE PALACIOS, state and declare:

I am a defendant in the above-entitled matter, and I am authorized to make this verification on my behalf.

I have read the foregoing DEFENDANT KATIE PALACIOS' RESPONSES TO PLAINTIFF'S REQUESTS FOR ADMISSION, SET ONE and know the contents thereof. I am informed and believe the matters stated therein are true and, on that ground, I allege the matters stated therein are true.

I declare under penalty of perjury under the laws of the State of California that the foregoing is true and correct.

Executed at STOCKTON, California on June 8, 2026.

Katie Palacios

KATIE PALACIOS

PROOF OF SERVICE

I, Kim Schmitt, certify and declare as follows:

I am over the age of 18 years, and not a party to this action. My business address is 1478 Stone Point Drive, Suite 450, Roseville, CA 95661. My business email is: kschmitt@sims-law.net. I am employed in the County of Placer where this service occurs. My business email address is: kschmitt@sims-law.net.

On the date set forth below, following ordinary business practice, I served a true copy of the foregoing document(s) described as:

DEFENDANT KATIE PALACIOS' RESPONSES TO PLAINTIFF'S REQUESTS FOR ADMISSION, SET ONE

☐ (BY MAIL) I am readily familiar with my employer's normal business practice for collection and processing of correspondence for mailing with the U.S. Postal Service. Correspondence so collected and processed is deposited with the U.S. Postal Service that same day in the ordinary course of business. I placed for deposit in the United States Postal Service in a sealed envelope, with postage fully prepaid, to the addressee(s) below.

☐ (BY PERSONAL SERVICE) I personally delivered the above document(s) by hand between 9:00 a.m. and 5:00 p.m. to the office of the addressee(s) below.

☐ (BY OVERNIGHT DELIVERY) I deposited in a box or other facility regularly maintained by Federal Express an express service carrier, or delivered to a courier or driver authorized by said express service carrier to receive such envelope(s) to be delivered by overnight delivery, with delivery fees paid or provided for, addressed to the person(s) on whom it is to be served below.

☒ (BY ELECTRONIC SERVICE) I transmitted via electronic service through electronic mail to the offices of the addressee(s) below as stated on the attached service list on this date before 5:00 p.m.

SEE ATTACHED SERVICE LIST

☒ (State) I certify and declare under penalty of perjury under the laws of the State of California that the foregoing is true and correct.

Executed on: June 8, 2026

Kim Schmitt

SERVICE LIST

Brendan Ngehsi Newanforbi Plaintiff, in Pro Per 1455 Cat Tail Drive Stockton, CA 95204 (209) 801-4442 E: bnn.cdl@gmail.com	**PLAINTIFF, IN PER**